

A330 Weather Requirements, FOM 125.3

34 dispatch and weather rules from FOM 125.3 (15 SEP 26), grouped as the quiz drills them. Fleet-common FOM text; A330 rows quoted where the FOM banners fleets.
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Item	Requirement	FOM
Takeoff Minimums		
Standard takeoff minimums (aircraft with 2 engines or less)?	1 sm visibility or RVR 5000 .	5.4.1.1
Published takeoff minimums are higher than 1 sm / RVR 5000 and no special procedure (e.g. RNP departure) is available. May you depart below the published minimums?	No . Takeoff in weather less than published minimums shall not be made.	5.4.1.2
At what visibility must the Captain make the takeoff?	Visibility less than or equal to 1/4 sm or RVR 1600 .	5.4.3
Lowest takeoff RVR authorized for the A330, and the runway equipment it needs?	RVR 500 (150 m) : TDZ 500, MID 500, Rollout 500, with CL and HIRL . Below 500 RVR is 737/787 only (HGS/HUD takeoff briefing card). No A330 row exists. At 1200 (350 m) and below, if RVR is reported all 3 control (2 RVR required).	5.4.4
Takeoff Alternate		
When is a takeoff alternate required?	When reported departure weather is below the approach landing minimums for the runway of intended use , excluding any SA CAT I or CAT II/III approaches, or conditions exist that would preclude a return . Required but not on the release: contact Dispatch before takeoff and amend the release . Low visibility takeoff table note: when departure conditions reduce to below CAT I landing limits , a takeoff alternate is required (FOM 5.4.4).	5.4.2
Maximum distance from the departure airport to a takeoff alternate for the A330?	370 nm . A321 360 nm · A330 370 nm · 717 320 nm · 737 350 nm · 787 393 nm	5.4.2
What weather must a takeoff alternate meet?	The same requirements as the destination alternate (derived alternate minimums, FOM 8.2.2.1).	5.4.2
Destination Alternate		
Within the contiguous 48 states, or within the Hawaiian Islands: when is no destination alternate required?	Destination weather at ETA +/- 1 hour at least 2000 ft ceiling and 3 sm visibility (the 1-2-3 rule). Applies within the contiguous 48, into the contiguous 48 from Alaska / Mexico / Central America / Canada / Caribbean, and within the Hawaiian Islands .	8.2.3
Flag operation excluding A012 (e.g. Hawaii to the mainland): no-alternate ceiling and visibility?	Ceiling , ETA +/- 1 hour: straight-in available, at least 1500 ft above the lowest published IAP minimum or 2000 ft above airport elevation, whichever is higher ; circling required, 1500 ft above the lowest circling MDA. Visibility: 3 sm or 2 sm more than the applicable minimum, whichever is greater .	8.2.3
Flag flight planned at more than 6 hours, or a planned redispach to/from Hawaii. Alternate?	Flag flight planned more than 6 hours flight time on the Flight Plan: an alternate must be listed regardless of forecast. Planned redispach to/from Hawaii : must depart with an alternate for the intended destination (FOM 8.5.9).	8.2.3
Which forecast items require an alternate on the release regardless of ceiling and visibility?	Thunderstorms or volcanic ash forecast in the TAF at the ETA. A Dispatcher may add an alternate for other considerations.	8.2.3
After dispatch, the destination alternate weather drops below the minimums it was dispatched under. What happens?	The alternate must continue to meet the minimums it was dispatched under . Below them, Dispatch files a new alternate that does, or removes the alternate if the destination no longer requires one. No alternate can be found: divert , unless in the interest of safety the PIC continues to the destination under emergency authority . New in Rev 125.3.	8.2.2.1.1
Extended overwater flag flight, destination forecast below minimums at ETA. Can Dispatch release it?	Yes, ETOPS flights only : if the destination alternate is forecast at or above derived alternate minimums at the ETA. Domestic and overland flag flights may not be dispatched unless destination visibility or ceiling (if required) will be at or above minimums at ETA.	8.4.1.4
Forecast wind at the destination exceeds Company limits. Dispatch requirement?	An alternate must be listed that is forecast to remain within wind limits at the ETA at the alternate.	8.4.1.4
Alternate Minimums		
Derived alternate minimums, ONE navigational facility (straight-in non-precision, CAT I, or circling). Additives?	Add 400 ft to the MDA(H) or DA(H), and add 1 sm (1600 m) to the landing minimum.	8.2.2.1
Derived alternate minimums, TWO facilities to different suitable runways (two approach ends). Additives?	Add 200 ft to the higher DA(H)/MDA(H) of the two, and add 1/2 sm (800 m) to the higher authorized landing minimum of the two.	8.2.2.1
Jeppesen "For Filing As Alternate" minimums, additive rounding, and wind at the alternate?	Jeppesen 10-9/10-9A alternate minimums do not apply ; use the derived table. Additives apply only to the height (H) value, rounded up to the next 100 ft. Wind including gust must be forecast within operating limits (including reduced visibility limits) and should be within the manufacturer maximum demonstrated crosswind.	8.2.2.1
When is a second (marginal weather) alternate required?	Destination ceiling (if required) and/or visibility at or below CAT I minimums for the intended runway and approach, and the first alternate is at alternate minimums (ceiling or visibility). Also for a flag or supplemental flight to an international airport missing METAR information ; both alternates need a complete METAR and TAF.	8.2.2.2
Exemption 20108 (conditional TAF language): what does it allow, and does it apply to flag operations?	Domestic dispatch when TEMPO / PROB language says destination and/or first alternate may be below minimums at ETA. Conditional weather not less than 1/2 the lowest visibility minimum at destination, not less than 1/2 the alternate ceiling and visibility at the first alternate; a second alternate is always listed. Not authorized for flag operations , nor for international destinations flown under domestic rules.	8.2.2.3
ETOPS Alternate		
Weather required to list an ETOPS alternate on the release, and over what window?	At or above the Ops Spec C055 alternate minima (derived alternate minimums, FOM 8.2.2) for the earliest to latest possible landing time at that airport. Field condition reports must indicate a safe landing can be made. Earliest and latest arrival times are printed on the release.	6.2.2
In flight, what weather must an ETOPS alternate meet before the EEP, and what if it goes below that after the EEP?	Before the EEP : alternate weather at or above the crew operating minima (less restrictive than the dispatch criteria). If an ETOPS alternate is no longer available, a turnback is required. After the EEP : turnback not required ; establish a new ETOPS alternate with Dispatch. No METAR obtainable for the alternate: a new alternate must be designated.	6.3.5
Prohibited		
Takeoff and landing prohibited: wind, crosswind, braking action, and the A330 contaminated prepared width?	Steady-state wind greater than 50 kt . Crosswind exceeding fleet-specific manual limits (A330: FCOM). Braking action NIL or RWYCC 0 on any portion of the runway. Contaminated runway prepared surface width less than 45 m / 148 ft (A330).	9.2.1
Takeoff and landing prohibited: thunderstorms, freezing rain, icing?	TS at or near the airport unless the runway and flight path, including missed approach, are clear of the storms. Moderate or greater freezing rain (takeoff still allowed with an LWE-derived HOT, absent another prohibiting factor). Severe icing reported by a similar type or larger aircraft.	9.2.1
Takeoff prohibited: contaminant depth and tailwind?	Contaminant depth greater than 1/2 inch wet snow, slush, or water, or greater than 4 inches dry snow. Steady-state tailwind over 10 kt on a contaminated runway.	9.2.1

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Landing prohibited on a contaminated runway: which conditions?	Contaminated runway without a PIREP or FICON . LDA less than 7000 ft and braking action less than GOOD, with any of: tailwind over 5 kt , any inoperative thrust reverser , antiskid inoperative , or compact snow/ice with drizzle or rain of any intensity. Not recommended (logbook entry and damage inspection if done): water/slush/wet snow over 1/2 inch, dry snow over 4 inches (9.2.1.1).	9.2.1
Contaminated Runway		
(HA) definition of a contaminated runway?	More than 25% of the runway area in use covered by frost, ice, compact snow, more than 1/8 inch (3 mm) of liquid water, or any depth of slush, dry snow, or wet snow . (AS) wording differs: more than 1/8 inch of water, slush, dry snow, or wet snow. (HA) treats any depth of slush or snow as contaminated.	9.1.1.1
RWYCC range, where the A330 RCAM lives, and FLEX on a contaminated runway?	RWYCC runs 0 (NIL) to 6 (dry) . A330 RCAM (with runway-condition wind limits): FCOM In-Flight Performance . Reduced thrust by assumed temperature (FLEX) is not authorized on a contaminated runway.	9.1.6.1
Braking action worse than GOOD: who gets a report, and how may the A330 send it to Dispatch?	PIREP to ATC anytime actual braking action is less than GOOD or Braking Action Advisories are in effect, with descriptive terms and aircraft type. Worst braking action experienced to Dispatch after landing ; the ACARS FLT SUMMARY may be used (737/787/A321/A330, A330 added in Rev 125.3).	9.1.2.2
A330 in-flight landing distance: what assumptions does the TALPA calculation use?	7-second air/flare distance from 50 ft over the threshold to touchdown, plus a 15% safety margin on total landing distance (air distance included), for both max manual braking and autobrake.	5.6.22.3
Approach		
When may you begin the final approach segment, and what if a below-minimums report arrives after that?	Only when the latest reported RVR, visibility, or ceiling (if required) is at or above the authorized minimums. Below-minimums report after the final segment has begun: continue to DA/DH or MDA . Non-precision and CAT I: TDZ RVR controls ; Mid may substitute if TDZ is unavailable. Visibility below 1/2 sm is not authorized for approach minimums.	5.6.11
A330 CAT II / CAT III: crosswind limit, and one-engine-inoperative autoland?	Crosswind less than the AFM limit or 15 kt, whichever is more restrictive . One-engine-inoperative CAT II autoland is authorized by Ops Spec; one-engine CAT III autoland is not authorized . The PIC must be Autoland qualified.	5.6.17
Controlling Report		
Which weather report is controlling?	The most recent report , including Remarks or conditional language. A verbal tower report of visibility, RVV, or RVR takes precedence over METAR or ATIS.	9.2.1
A330 Specific		
Decompression polygon: A330 initial descent altitude?	Always 17,000 ft or FL170 (737 and A330). The 787 uses the altitude in the polygon detail drawer. Never proceed through a charted No Ops Area. Plan to be at 10,000 ft before passenger oxygen is depleted (11.2.9). Polygon procedures renumbered 11.2.9.1 in Rev 125.3.	11.2.9.1
Narrow runway: definition, and is the A330 allowed?	Nominal paved width less than 100 ft (30 m) . Not authorized for A330 takeoff or landing (717/787/A321/A330). Only the 737 has narrow-runway restrictions.	5.1.3